

Medicinal Properties of Leaf Species

Source: Dr. Shivarama Karantha Pilikula Nisargadhama, Mangaluru, Karnataka
<https://pilikula.karnataka.gov.in>

This document covers 7 of the 32 species in the LeafMind dataset for which verified medicinal-property reference data was available from the source above. The remaining 25 species are not covered by this source and are not included here.

Mesua_ferrea

Scientific Name: *Mesua ferrea* L.

Family: Clusiaceae

Common Names: Nagasampige, Nagakesara (Kannada); Nanga, Peri (Malayalam); Bhujangakhya, Kanchana, Kesara (Sanskrit); Indian Rose Chestnut (English)

Description: Evergreen trees reaching 30 m tall with smooth, ash-colored bark. Leaves opposite, variable shape (linear-lanceolate to elliptic-oblong), 6-15 cm long, displaying color changes from crimson red to pink to dark green. Flowers axillary/terminal, solitary, white, bisexual, sweet-scented, yellow stamens. Fruits ovoid to globose, 2.5-3.5 cm, containing 1-4 seeds.

Medicinal Properties and Traditional Uses:

Bark tonic after child birth, used in anaemia; bark and flower bechic; bark and unripe fruit sudorific; bark, unripe fruit and flower astringent. Leaf and flower antidote for snakebite and scorpion sting. Flower-bud used in dysentery; flower stomachic, expectorant, used in piles, burning of feet. Seed oil used in skin diseases and rheumatism. In Ayurveda, anthers used in diseases of head, throat, urinary bladder disorders, poisoning, nausea, vomiting, leprosy, erysipelas, thirst and piles.

Other Uses: Seed oil for soap production; wood used for railway sleepers, bridges, and construction; volatile oil used in perfuming soaps.

Pongamia_pinnata

Scientific Name: *Pongamia pinnata* (L.) Pierre

Family: Fabaceae

Common Names: Honge mara, Karanja (Kannada); Pugu, Punnu, Pungam (Malayalam); Kanuga (Tamil); Ponga (Telugu)

Description: Nearly evergreen trees reaching 15 m tall with greyish-green bark. Leaves compound with 5-9 opposite leaflets, 10-20 cm long overall. Flowers in 15 cm axillary racemes with pinkish-white petals. Fruits indehiscent pods approximately 6 x 3.5 cm with a single reniform seed. Flowering: March-June. Fruiting: June-December.

Medicinal Properties and Traditional Uses:

Twigs used for cleaning teeth; juice of roots used for cleaning teeth. Seed oil (Pongam oil) applied externally to scabies, herpes, sores, leucoderma. Seeds valued as febrifuge and tonic, used in bronchitis and whooping-cough. In Ayurveda, bark, leaf and seed used in oedema, poisoning, piles, worm infection, leprosy. Specialized formulations "Prithvisara Taila" and "Tiktadya Ghrita" used for skin diseases and ulcers.

Santalum_album

Scientific Name: Santalum album L.

Family: Santalaceae

Common Names: Srigantha (Kannada); Chandanam (Malayalam); Chandana, Taliaparnam (Sanskrit); Sandanam (Tamil); Chandanamu (Telugu); Sandalwood tree (English)

Description: Small evergreen trees reaching 10 m tall with slender drooping branches and grey bark. Facultative root parasites when young. Opposite or whorled leaves (4-8 x 1.5-4 cm), brownish-purple flowers in terminal and axillary panicles. Purple-black drupes (1-1.5 cm) with solitary seeds. Flowering & Fruiting: March-August. Distribution: Western Peninsula, India.

Medicinal Properties and Traditional Uses:

Wood febrifuge, diaphoretic, anti-inflammatory, used in headache. Wood oil stimulant, antigonorrhoeic, expectorant, used as urinary antiseptic in dysuria, used in bronchitis, gleet, tuberculosis of gall bladder. Also used for skin diseases, worm infestation, fever, and polyuria. Heartwood produces a valuable essential oil via distillation, used in incense making and religious ceremonies. Stem-bark addresses malaria; paste formulations address multiple conditions including debility and emaciation.

Saraca_indica (recorded on source as Saraca asoca)

Scientific Name: *Saraca asoca* (Roxb.) Wilde

Family: Caesalpiniaceae

Common Names: Ashokada mara (Kannada); Asoka, Asokam, Hema pushpam (Malayalam); Asogam, Asoka (Tamil & Telugu)

Description: Small trees reaching 10-12 m tall with even-pinnate leaves.

Leaflets 3-6 pairs, 13-23 x 5-8 cm. Showy axillary flowers in yellow, orange, or red, in dense corymbose panicles. Dehiscing flat pods (5-15 x 2.5 cm) with obovate-orbicular seeds. Flowering: December-January. Fruiting: May-July.

Medicinal Properties and Traditional Uses:

Bark astringent, antibilious, uterine sedative — used for leucorrhoea, menorrhagia and other menstrual disorders. Also used for hemorrhoids, dyspepsia, and skin conditions. Bark and flower antibilious, used for haemorrhagic dysentery. Flower functions as a uterine tonic, antidiabetic, antisyphilitic agent. In Ayurvedic medicine, bark addresses worm infestation, polyuria, fever, leprosy and gynaecological disorders. The preparation "Ashokarishta" is prescribed in leucorrhoea, haematuria, menorrhagia and other diseases of the genito-urinary system of females.

Syzygium_zeylanicum

Scientific Name: *Syzygium zeylanicum* (L.) DC.

Family: Myrtaceae

Common Names: Kunnerale, Bilinerale (Kannada); Pula (Malayalam)

Description: A tree with pale brown bark and opposite, ovate to elliptic-lanceolate leaves (7-9 x 2.5-3.2 cm). Small white flowers in axillary and terminal paniculate cymes. Fruit a globose white berry approximately 8 mm across, containing a solitary seed. Flowering/Fruiting: February-May.

Distribution: Western Peninsular India, Orissa, Silhet; upper Western Ghats forest undergrowth (600-900 m elevation); also Sri Lanka, Sumatra, Borneo, Malaya.

Medicinal Properties and Traditional Uses:

Plant stimulant, used in rheumatism, syphilis, uterine problems; decoction of leaf and root used as vermifuge.

Other Uses: Edible fruits; timber for construction and agricultural implements; bark yields a black dye.

Terminalia_arjuna

Scientific Name: Terminalia arjuna (Roxb. ex DC.) Wight & Arn.

Family: Combretaceae

Common Names: Bili mathi (Kannada); Vella marutu (Malayalam); Arjuna, Dhananjaya (Sanskrit); Vellamarda, Kula maruthu (Tamil); Tittu maddi (Telugu)

Description: Large deciduous trees reaching 25 m tall with smooth, greenish-white bark that peels in flat pieces. Sub-opposite leaves elliptic-lanceolate, up to 15 x 7 cm, slightly serrated edges. Yellowish flowers in paniced spikes. Fruits are woody drupes with five hard projecting wings. Flowering & Fruiting: March-May. Distribution: throughout India, common in deciduous forests of the Western Ghats and coastal regions along rivers and streams; also Sri Lanka.

Medicinal Properties and Traditional Uses:

Bark: styptic, antidysenteric, astringent, antiasthmatic, febrifuge, expectorant, antibilious, cardiotonic, aphrodisiac, diuretic. Addresses fractures, ulcers, anemia, leucoderma, and excessive perspiration. Leaves treat earache; fruits provide deobstruent properties. Bark also used as a tanning agent and for feeding tasar silkworms.

Trewia_nudiflora

Family: Euphorbiaceae

Common Names: Pambara kumbil (Malayalam); Ana-thuvarai (Tamil)

Description: Trees reaching up to 15 m tall with subopposite, broadly ovate leaves (up to 20 cm long), truncate or cordate at base, acuminate at apex, petioles up to 7.5 cm long. Flowers appear before leaves; male flowers in short racemes, female flowers in many-flowered racemes up to 7.5 cm long. Globosely ovoid drupes approximately 1.3 cm in diameter, densely covered with fine hairs. Flowering & Fruiting: March-July. Distribution: endemic to

India's Western Ghats and West Coast in wet places and along streams
(Maharashtra, Karnataka, Tamil Nadu, Kerala).

Medicinal Properties and Traditional Uses:

No medicinal or therapeutic uses are documented for this species in the source material. The primary documented use is non-medicinal: wood is soft, used for making drums and for carving images.

Species Not Covered by This Source

The following 25 species from the LeafMind dataset do not have a matching entry on the Pilikula Nisargadhama plant database and are not included above: *Cinnamomum_tamala*, *Myxopyrum_smilacifolium*, *Plectranthus_vettiveroides*, *Putranjiva_roxburghii*, *Rauvolfia_tetraphylla*, *Rivinia_humilis*, *Samadhera_indica*, *Sansevieria_zeylanica*, *Sauropus_androgynus*, *Schaueria_flavicomma*, *Simarouba_glauca*, *Solanum_diphyllum*, *Solanum_torvum*, *Solanum_virginianum*, *Sphagneticola_trilobata*, *Streblus_asper*, *Syzygium_gardneri*, *Syzygium_hemisphericum*, *Syzygium_samarangense*, *Tabernaemontana_alternifolia*, *Tamarindus_indica*, *Thespesia_populnea*, *Tithonia_diversifolia*, *Vetiveria_zizanioides*, *Woodfordia_fruiticosa*.